PROJECT SYNDICATE DIGEST

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1. The Politics of Poland’s Judicial Crisis

Author: Maciej Kisilowski **Published:** Nov 1, 2026 **Link:** View Original

WARSAW—Dramatic scenes are playing out at Poland’s Constitutional Tribunal amid a wave of speculation about whether Prime Minister Donald Tusk’s government and the Tribunal judges elected by its liberal parliamentary majority are acting lawfully. Many will ask whether democrats must break the law to restore institutions sabotaged by populist authoritarians. In the Polish case, it’s the wrong question.

2. A Tory Mentor for the MAGA GOP

Author: Michael R. Strain **Published:** Nov 2, 2026 **Link:** View Original

WASHINGTON, DC—“There is a fight coming in British politics. A fight that we have not seen in this country for more than half a century. It will be a battle for the soul of this nation. A battle of ideas. A battle that goes to the very core of who we are and what kind of country we want to be.”

3. If AI Thinks for Us, Democracy Will Suffer

Author: John Palfrey **Published:** Nov 2, 2026 **Link:** View Original

CHICAGO—Sometime in the 18th century, the Enlightenment settled a contentious, centuries-old question: Where does knowledge come from? For millennia, many people had pointed to God. But the early modern period brought a new consensus, namely that knowledge comes from human scientists working at the edge of what is known, armed with observation, mathematics, experimentation, and logic.

4. A Debtors’ Club for a Fragmented World

Author: Ishac Diwan **Published:** Nov 2, 2026 **Link:** View Original

BANGKOK—For seven decades, some of the world’s biggest official creditors have coordinated their positions in negotiations with debtor countries struggling with repayment. The Paris Club has sought not only to tackle debt treatment for individual sovereigns, but also to shape the rules governing bailouts and conditionality, largely by leveraging its 22 permanent members’ influence at the International Monetary Fund. Now, the world’s debtors have created a club of their own. The question is whether its stated goals are sufficiently ambitious.

5. Trump’s Tariff Fiasco Could Save Free Trade

Author: Anne O. Krueger **Published:** Nov 2, 2026 **Link:** View Original

WASHINGTON, DC—In the nearly two years since he returned to the White House, US President Donald Trump has picked up where he left off in his first term, shredding the open multilateral trading system that has served the world so well since the end of World War II. He has imposed sweeping tariffs on dozens of countries, repeatedly raising and lowering them and changing rates on individual goods and countries, seemingly on a whim. As a result, US tariff rates are now higher than at any time since the Great Depression’s Smoot-Hawley tariffs.

6. Europe’s Bright Future

Author: Thomas Buberl **Published:** Nov 3, 2026 **Link:** View Original

PARIS—I was born in Germany, I studied in Switzerland and the United Kingdom, and I served as a reserve officer in the French Navy. Today, I am a French citizen leading a French company that operates in more than 50 countries. I am, above all, a European.

7. Poland’s Constitutional Civil War

Author: Sławomir Sierakowski **Published:** Nov 3, 2026 **Link:** View Original

WARSAW—In a shocking moment that went viral, Polish President Karol Nawrocki and his cronies were recently filmed breaking into the Constitutional Tribunal in the dead of night and brutally shoving aside the judges they encountered, including an elderly woman. What or who were they coming for?

8. The Tech Brotherhood Wants Sovereignty

Author: Katharina Pistor **Published:** Nov 3, 2026 **Link:** View Original

NEW YORK—Over several centuries, nation-states have come to define the international system and govern much of humanity. After emerging in modern Europe and spreading through colonialism, they eventually made it to every corner of the world through postwar decolonization. Their defining feature is control over territory and its inhabitants, without interference by others.

9. The Far Right’s Vision for Europe

Author: Mark Leonard **Published:** Nov 3, 2026 **Link:** View Original

BERLIN—Recent events have cast European politics into sharper relief. With left-wing protests, some violent, engulfing cities from Paris to Milan to Madrid, the right has remained focused on big upcoming elections, and most mainstream parties appeared to be in retreat. It may be too soon to guess at the outcomes in Spain, France, Poland, and Italy, but there can be little doubt that far-right and populist ideas will shape the Europe that emerges from these contests. That much is clear to me after spending the past few months talking to leading “new right” politicians and strategists in France, Poland, Germany, and Italy.

10. Oligarchic World Order

Author: David Lingelbach **Published:** Nov 3, 2026 **Link:** View Original

BALTIMORE/BOGOTÁ—For most people, the word “oligarch” conjures images of Russian elites who amassed huge fortunes in the wake of the Soviet Union’s collapse or, more recently, the tech billionaires who filled the front row at US President Donald Trump’s second inauguration. But oligarchs are global, systemic, and increasingly entrenched. They are a defining feature of the emerging world order.